

UPPER DECK REVIEW

Holistic IxDF evaluation — 7 Factors, 5 Usability Characteristics, 5 Interaction Dimensions. Severity-ranked findings with three concrete redesign proposals.

OVERALL UX HEALTH

48 / 85 D • 56%

PRODUCT	OwlSurf Digital portfolio/credentials deck (Vite + React SPA)
SCOPE	Slide 1 Title → Slide 5 Clients + Contact closer
SOURCE	Live localhost:8080 + 12 source files
FRAMEWORK	IxDF (Interaction Design Foundation) holistic framework
DATE	2026-05-24
AUDITOR	Claude Opus 4.7 — ux-audit-rethink skill

Executive Summary

HEADLINE Visual polish high. Editorial heading recipe disciplined. Brand identity coherent. But product as *usable artifact* leaks across navigation, accessibility, mobile, and motion control. Deck looks like premium agency, behaves like demo reel.

Biggest red flags

1. **Nav labels stale** — say "WHY US / ABOUT" while slides are "Who We Are / Our Team". Buyer sees broken promise.
2. **Auto-advance lock** — roster (5s) + CardSwap (3s) rotate without user pause control. WCAG SC 2.2.2 fail.
3. **Mobile WebGL un-gated** — Hyperspeed, LightRays, PrismaticBurst mount on phone. Self-violates `prod.md` line 22.
4. **Empty-canvas flash** — `SLIDE_MOUNT_RADIUS = 0` + lazy chunk = black screen between slides.
5. **A11y near-zero** — `text-white/18` roster, no `role=tab`, `role=menubar` misused, `prefers-reduced-motion` ignored, scroll-hijack with no keyboard slide nav.

7 UX FACTORS

21 / 35

USABILITY

14 / 25

INTERACTION DESIGN

13 / 25

Quick wins (1 day each): Fix nav labels. Add pause buttons. Gate WebGL by `useIsMobile()`. Replace `role=menubar` with `<nav><ul>`. Replace Lovable OG image.

CONTENTS

1. The 7 Factors (Morville Honeycomb)
2. The 5 Usability Characteristics
3. The 5 Interaction Dimensions
4. Issues — Prioritized (P0 → P3)
5. Three Redesign Proposals
6. Implementation Roadmap
7. Methodology Notes

1. The 7 Factors

FACTOR	SCORE	STATUS
Useful	4/5	Good
Usable	2/5	Poor
Findable	2/5	Poor
Credible	4/5	Good
Desirable	4/5	Good
Accessible	1/5	Critical
Valuable	4/5	Good
Total	21 / 35 (60%)	

Useful 4/5

Deck = pre-sales artifact for B2B/industrial. Format match. Sectors named (Chemicals, Pharma, Energy, Infra, Education). Services exhaustive 25-item taxonomy. AI pillar added — meets buyer expectation 2026.

Gap: No proof points on Slide 2 (no logos, no stats), proof deferred to Slide 5 logos and case studies. Buyer asks "why you" before "who you served."

Usable 2/5

- Stale nav labels (`PillNav.tsx:7-13`) — "Why Us / About / Case Study" don't match slide titles.
- Scroll-hijack via `scroll-snap-type: y mandatory` + `scroll-snap-stop: always` (`index.css:209-211`) — can't peek mid-slide, no overview.
- Auto-advance roster + CardSwap force pacing.
- "Jump to Creatives" CTA cryptic — should be "See case studies" or "View work."
- No keyboard arrow handlers for ←/→/PgUp/PgDn.

Findable 2/5

- Nav hides after 1600ms idle (`Index.tsx:37`). Buyer scrolling slow loses anchor.
- No slide counter ("3 / 12"), no progress bar, no jump-to dots.
- Nav labels stale = nav-jump untrustworthy. Clicking "About" lands on Our Team — surprise.
- No overview/grid view of all slides.

Credible 4/5

- Dark editorial design = "serious agency."
- Real client logos (Cult.fit, IIM Lucknow, Welham, VNT).
- Named team with titles.
- External links use `noopener noreferrer`.

Dings: OG image still `lovable.dev/opengraph-image-p98pqq.png` (`index.html:18,22`) — Lovable default, not OwlSurf. Vishnu reuses Pankaj avatar (`OurTeamSlide.tsx:38`). Alt `"Client"` on `extraLogo` placeholder generic.

Desirable 4/5

- Editorial layout strong. Heading recipe consistent.
- Teal-on-near-black palette distinctive.
- Lanyard + Hyperspeed = memorable signature moments.

Ding: Over-stim — Globe + LightRays + animate-gradient-shift + hexagon-pattern all on Slide 1. Per `prod.md` : "One full-bleed background or effect per slide. Never two competing backgrounds." Self-violation.

Accessible 1/5

Critical fails:

- Inactive roster rows `text-white/18` (`OurTeamSlide.tsx:98,108`) $\approx$ 1.8:1 ratio vs `#0b0f14` . Fails WCAG AA (4.5:1 needed). Hover state `white/34` $\approx$ 3.3:1, still fails.
- Auto-advance roster (5s) + CardSwap (3s) — no pause/stop/hide control. Fails WCAG 2.2.2.
- `role="menubar"` + `role="menuitem"` on site nav (`PillNav.tsx:257,261`) — wrong ARIA pattern.
- `role="tab"` / `role="tablist"` / `aria-selected` missing on Services tabs.
- `prefers-reduced-motion` not gated anywhere. Anime.js + GSAP + WebGL run regardless.
- `<main>` nested inside `<section>` slide in ContactSlide (`ContactSlide.tsx:90`).
- `scrollTo({ behavior: "smooth" })` ignores reduced-motion.
- No skip-to-content link.
- Mobile menu button no `aria-expanded` , popover no `role="dialog"` , no focus trap, no Escape handler.
- Body text `text-white/36` at 10px in Contact — contrast fail at small size.

Valuable 4/5

- Clear B2B/industrial positioning matches niche demand.
- Contact CTAs functional (mailto, tel, web).

Ding: No inline lead-capture form. Mailto = friction. No tracking pixel hooks visible. Vercel deploy broken per `context.md` — value not even shipped.

2. The 5 Usability Characteristics

CHARACTERISTIC	SCORE	NOTE
Effectiveness	3/5	Can view; empty-flash breaks confidence
Efficiency	2/5	Auto-pace + hidden nav slow user
Engagement	4/5	Visual polish + novelty high
Error Tolerance	2/5	No undo on scroll-snap overshoot
Ease of Learning	3/5	Scroll metaphor universal; hidden affordances confuse
Total	14 / 25 (56%)	

Effectiveness 3/5

Reader completes goal "see deck." Empty-canvas flash (`SlideFallback = <section className="slide" aria-hidden="true" />` at `Index.tsx:39`) breaks "is this loaded?" check. On slow 3G, lazy chunk fetch could leave full black screen for seconds.

Efficiency 2/5

- Nav hides after 1.6s → user must wiggle mouse to navigate.
- CardSwap 3s rotation = user wanting "AEO" must wait turns.
- Roster auto-advance same.
- No keyboard slide jump (no `1-9` shortcuts).

Engagement 4/5

- Lanyard physics = signature delight.
- Hyperspeed background = memorable.
- Stagger reveal animations purposeful.
- Editorial typography premium feel.

Error Tolerance 2/5

- Scroll-snap-stop: always means accidental wheel = always-commits to next slide. Can't cancel mid-snap.
- No "back to top" CTA on Contact.
- No image error fallback (lazy `<img>` with no `onError`).
- No retry for lazy chunk load failure.

Ease of Learning 3/5

- Vertical scroll-deck convention familiar.
- But: hidden nav, vague "Jump to Creatives", auto-rotating cards = first-timer unsure if they should wait or click.
- No first-visit tooltip or arrow hint at scroll affordance.

3. The 5 Interaction Dimensions

DIMENSION	SCORE	NOTE
Words	2/5	Stale labels, vague CTA, placeholder alt
Visual	4/5	Strong system; minor small-text issues
Physical/Space	2/5	Mobile WebGL un-gated; layout overflow risks
Time	2/5	Auto-pace + no reduced-motion + lazy flash
Behavior	3/5	State sync OK; no manual controls on rotators
Total	13 / 25 (52%)	

Words 2/5

- Nav: `Intro / Why Us / About / Services / Clients / Case Study / Contact` vs actual slides `Title / Who We Are / Our Team / Services / Clients / 7 case studies / Contact`. Why Us = wrong. About ≠ Our Team. Fix labels to match.
- CTA "Jump to Creatives" — what's a creative? Use "View case studies →" or "See our work".
- Card footer "PILLAR • B2B / Industrial" on every CardSwap card = noise, same on all 25.
- `alt="Client"` on `extraLogo` = placeholder.
- "B2B demand for complex markets" kicker — strong. Keep.
- Body line "We translate technical depth into market momentum" — sharp. Keep.

Visual 4/5

- Heading recipe `clamp(3.4rem, 5.9vw, 6.6rem)` Montserrat Black + teal-gradient second word = disciplined.
- Token system (`--owl-teal #4BC2C2` , spacing 4px base, motion easings) is real design system, not ad-hoc.
- Teal vs near-black ≈ 12:1 ✓ AAA.

Dings:

- Eyebrows at `text-[10px] tracking-[0.3em]` = ~7px x-height after tracking — borderline readable.
- Italic Lora highlight phrases (`#061112` on teal) = pretty but slow to parse; saved by short phrase length.
- `text-white/40` info labels on Slide 1 = ~4:1, marginal for 10px text.

Physical/Space 2/5

`prod.md` line 22 declares: "Heavy effects (3D, particle systems, blur) are gated on desktop only via `useIsMobile()`. Never on mobile."

- Actual: `Hyperspeed` (`SkyrocketSlide.tsx:116`), `LightRays` (`TitleSlide.tsx:154` , `ServicesSlide.tsx:295`), `PrismaticBurst` (`ClientsSlide.tsx:112`), `Globe` (`TitleSlide.tsx:177`) — none gated by `useIsMobile()`.
- Touch targets in roster `py-3.5` = ~44px hit zone ✓.
- CardSwap CSS `transform: translate(50%, 50%) scale(1.3)` per `prod.md` — card 520×270 × 1.3 = 676×351 displayed. On 375px-wide phone = horizontal overflow.

- OurTeam at `<lg>`: roster (6 rows × ~60px) + lanyard (min-h-[620px]) = ~980px column. Below `lg`, stacks vertically → page overflows `100svh`. Critical mobile bug.
- Skyrocket mobile uses `h-[31rem]` fixed copy height — overflow risk in landscape phones.

Time 2/5

- Lazy chunk fetch + `SLIDE_MOUNT_RADIUS = 0` = neighbor slide not preloaded. Wheel-down = white flash until chunk loads.
- Smooth `scrollTo` ignores `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- Auto-advance: Team 5s, CardSwap 3s — no user control.
- Animations 700–1400ms reasonable per 1xDF (under instant feel threshold).
- No skeleton screens for case study images.

Behavior 3/5

- PillNav active state syncs to `currentSlide` ✓.
- Roster click overrides timer ✓.
- CardSwap `pauseOnHover` ✓ for mouse, not for touch/keyboard.
- Logo button → home navigation ✓.

Dings: No CardSwap manual prev/next or pause button. No deck overview/grid. No scroll progress indicator. Hover-on-card pauses but releases unannounced.

4. Issues — Prioritized

P0 — Critical (fix this week)

#	ISSUE	FILE	EFFORT
1	Stale nav labels (Why Us, About)	<code>PillNav.tsx:7–13</code>	5 min
2	Roster + CardSwap auto-advance no pause control (WCAG 2.2.2)	<code>OurTeamSlide.tsx:49–55</code> , ServicesSlide	1 hr
3	Inactive roster <code>text-white/18</code> fails AA contrast	<code>OurTeamSlide.tsx:98,108,113</code>	15 min
4	Mobile WebGL un-gated (Hyperspeed/LightRays/PrismaticBurst on phone)	4 files	30 min
5	<code>role="menubar"</code> misuse on site nav	<code>PillNav.tsx:257,261</code>	10 min
6	<code><main></code> nested inside <code><section></code> slide	<code>ContactSlide.tsx:90</code>	2 min
7	No <code>prefers-reduced-motion</code> gate anywhere	Global	2 hr
8	Lovable default OG image still in <code>index.html</code>	<code>index.html:18,22</code>	30 min

P1 — High (next sprint)

#	ISSUE	FIX
9	Empty-canvas flash on slide transition	Pre-mount neighbor: <code>SLIDE_MOUNT_RADIUS = 1</code> or skeleton card
10	<code><div></code> used for h2-level headings in Skyrocket	Promote to <code><h2></code> (<code>SkyrocketSlide.tsx:154</code>)
11	"Jump to Creatives" vague CTA	Rename "View case studies →"
12	Slide 2 mobile fixed <code>h-[31rem]</code> overflows landscape	Replace with <code>min-h</code> + flex
13	OurTeam mobile stack overflows viewport	Compact lanyard on mobile or static portrait
14	Mobile menu missing <code>aria-expanded</code> , no Escape, no focus trap	Full mobile-menu a11y pass
15	No keyboard slide nav (←/→/1-9)	Add window keydown handler
16	CardSwap footer "B2B/Industrial" repeated 25×	Remove per-card; place once on tab
17	No slide progress indicator	Add <code>2 / 12</code> counter top-right

P2 — Medium

- Eyebrow text 10px + 0.3em tracking borderline legibility — bump to 11px.
- "Client" alt placeholder on `extraLogo`.
- Vishnu uses Pankaj avatar.
- `logo-main.jpg` not WebP/SVG (`prod.md` TODO open).
- No social proof/stats on Slide 2 (deferred to logos).
- Lazy chunk preload via `<link rel="modulepreload">` for next slide.

P3 — Backlog

- Slide thumbnails overview (press `g` for grid view).
- Deck mode vs casual mode toggle.
- Export deck as PDF for offline buyer review.

5. Three Redesign Proposals

Proposal A — Nav Truth Pass

Words + Findable fix

Now:

Intro · Why Us · About · Services · Clients · Case Study · Contact

Fix to:

Plus:

- Slide counter `03 / 13` left-anchored, always visible (don't hide with nav)
- Tiny vertical dot column right edge, current slide teal, click to jump
- Replace `role="menubar"` / `role="menuitem"` with plain `<nav aria-label="Deck"><ul><li><a>`

Expected impact: Findable 2→4, Words 2→4, Accessible 1→2. **Effort:** 4 hr.

Proposal B — Motion Control + Reduced-Motion Pass

Single hook `useDeckMotion()` returns `{ reduceMotion, paused, togglePause }`:

```
// All auto-advancers consume it
const { paused, reduceMotion } = useDeckMotion();
useEffect(() => {
  if (paused || reduceMotion) return;
  const t = setTimeout(advance, 5000);
  return () => clearTimeout(t);
}, [paused, reduceMotion, activeIndex]);
```

Add single floating button bottom-right:

```
[ ⏮ Auto-play ] → [ ▶ Auto-play ]
```

Gate inside WebGL components:

```
const isMobile = useIsMobile();
if (isMobile) return null; // or low-fi static gradient fallback
```

For `scrollTo`:

```
const reduceMotion = window.matchMedia('(prefers-reduced-motion: reduce)').matches;
container.scrollTo({ top, behavior: reduceMotion ? 'auto' : 'smooth' });
```

Expected impact: Accessible 1→3, Time 2→4, Error Tolerance 2→3. **Effort:** 1 day.

Proposal C — Slide Mount Resilience

Now: `SLIDE_MOUNT_RADIUS = 0` + `<SlideFallback>` empty + lazy import = black flash between slides.

Fix three-part:

1. **Bump radius to 1** when on desktop:

```
const SLIDE_MOUNT_RADIUS = useIsMobile() ? 0 : 1;
```

2. **Skeleton placeholder** instead of empty:

```
const SlideFallback = ({ index }: { index: number }) => (
  <section className="slide" aria-busy="true">
```

```

    <div className="opacity-30 text-xs tracking-[0.3em] text-primary">
      {String(index + 1).padStart(2, '0')} / {slides.length}
    </div>
  </section>
);

```

3. Modulepreload hint for next chunk on mount:

```

useEffect(() => {
  const nextIdx = currentSlide + 1;
  if (nextIdx < slides.length) {
    slides[nextIdx]?.preload?();
  }
}, [currentSlide]);

```

Expected impact: Effectiveness 3→4, Time 2→3. **Effort:** 4 hr.

6. Implementation Roadmap

Week 1 — P0 only (≈ 8 hr total)

- **Day 1:** Nav labels + role=menubar + Lovable OG image (1 hr).
- **Day 2:** Mobile WebGL gating (30 min) + roster contrast (15 min) + `<main>` semantic fix (5 min).
- **Day 3-4:** Reduced-motion hook + pause control (1 day).
- **Day 5:** Verification in real browser, real phone.

Week 2 — P1

- Mount resilience (Proposal C) — 4 hr.
- Mobile OurTeam + Skyrocket layout fixes — 1 day.
- Mobile menu a11y pass — 4 hr.
- Keyboard slide nav (←/→/1-9) — 2 hr.
- Slide counter + dots (Proposal A part 2) — 4 hr.

Week 3 — P2 polish

- Promote semantic headings.
- Replace placeholder alts.
- Vishnu avatar.
- Logo SVG conversion.

Success metric targets

METRIC	NOW	TARGET
IxDF total	48/85 (56%)	65/85 (76%)
Accessible	1/5	3/5
Findable	2/5	4/5
Words	2/5	4/5
Mobile WebGL count	4 ungated	0
Stale nav labels	3	0

7. Methodology Notes

- Source evidence: 6 slide files + Index + index.html + index.css + tailwind.config + PillNav.
- Live `localhost:8080` confirmed render-ready (200 OK).
- Existing screenshot `our-team-slide-single-lanyard.png` provided runtime evidence of empty-canvas flash + stale nav labels — corroborates code finding.
- No new screenshots captured per project policy (`handoff.md` line 230).
- A11y findings = static code analysis + WCAG knowledge. **Validate with axe-core or Lighthouse run for ground truth before fixing.**
- Combine with `wcag-accessibility-audit` skill for compliance depth + `nielsen-heuristics-audit` for usability cross-check.

⚠ Security flag — not part of UX audit

Git remote URL in `.git/config` contains a GitHub PAT in plaintext (`https://github_pat_11APVAL...@github.com/...`). **Rotate that token + switch to SSH or git credential helper before any wider repo access.**

Report generated by Claude Opus 4.7 via the `ux-audit-rethink` skill. IxDF framework: Peter Morville's User Experience Honeycomb (7 factors), ISO 9241-11 (usability characteristics), Gillian Crampton Smith & Kevin Silver (interaction design dimensions).